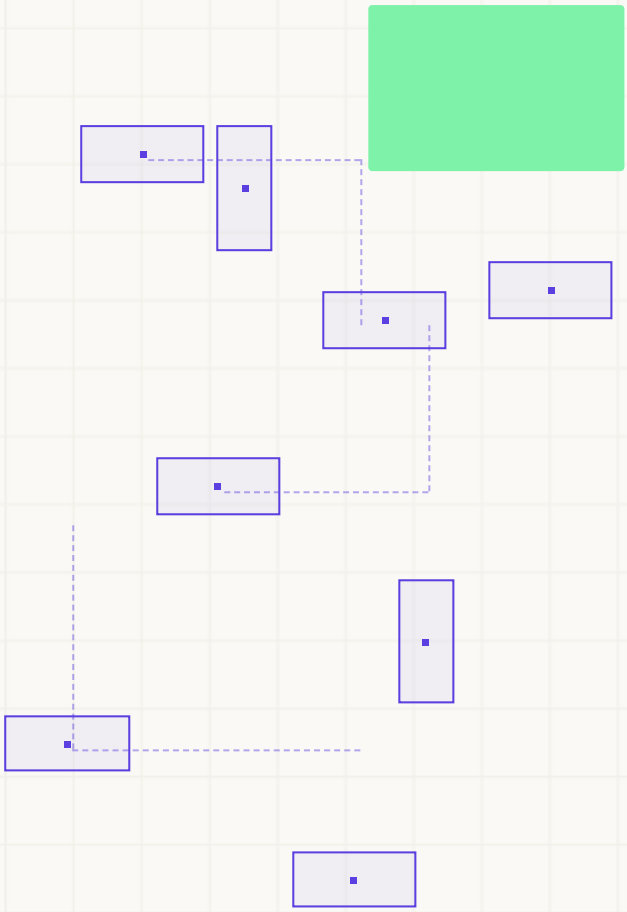
LAAI | AI FOR CONSTRUCTION



Start your AI journey

A practical guide for architecture offices, builders, contractors and real estate developers who want AI to save time and money, without a pile of new subscriptions.

INSIDE

A 5-step roadmap, a readiness check, a value worksheet and a 90-day plan

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EDITION

2026 · Málaga

WHY NOW

AI is a powerful tool. It pays off where work repeats.

Most offices already know AI could save them time. The hard part is knowing where to begin and what to trust. In construction, the biggest gains rarely come from a new platform. They come from small tools that take over the tasks your team repeats on every project.

Where AI pays off

- **Repetitive drafting:** hatching, area schedules, plan graphics
- **Quantities:** counts and areas straight from the 3D model
- **Checks:** naming, codes and model quality before every send-out
- **Scripts:** writing and fixing small tools for Rhino, Revit or Excel
- **Documents:** first drafts of reports, specs and summaries

Where people stay in charge

- **Design judgement** and the client relationship
- **Structural, fire and legal decisions** that need a qualified signature
- **Final numbers** that go to a client without a human check
- **A broken process:** automating it only makes the mess faster

AI drafts, people decide. The goal is a team that uses AI with confidence, and knows what to check.

USE

Use AI where it pays off

Find the repetitive work that costs your team the most hours.

BUILD

Build tools that work

Small tools tested on your real projects, not experiments on a shelf.

LEARN

Learn AI together

Habits your team keeps using, and knowing what to trust.

FIND THE OPPORTUNITY

Where the hours go in a construction business

Every branch has its own repetitive work. These are the tasks I see most often, and what a small tool or AI can take over.

BRANCH	REPETITIVE WORK	WHAT A TOOL OR AI CAN DO
Architecture offices	Hatching dozens of plans, area schedules, keeping graphics consistent	One-click hatching, automatic m² per apartment, AI-assisted floor plans
Modular and timber builders	Naming products, counting modules, checking CNC exports	Module size reports, live model quality checks, automated project counts
Contractors and estimators	Measuring quantities by hand, re-checking prices	Quantities from the 3D model to Excel, price calculators per element
BIM and design teams	Checking LOD / LOI, naming and IFC exports	Automatic model QA, Dynamo scripts, Revit templates
Real estate developers	Comparing plot options, unit counts and early costs	Massing options with areas, unit counts and early cost estimates

Five signs a task is ready for a tool

- ☐ The same task is done on every project, by hand
- ☐ People copy numbers from one program into another
- ☐ Errors are found late, by the client or in production
- ☐ Feedback lives in email, calls and several Excel files
- ☐ Only one person knows how a check is done

THE ROADMAP

Five steps from the first idea to a team that works with AI

Start small, measure, and only scale what works. Each step ends with something your team can use.

1

Map your process

List every step from tender to delivery. Mark the manual and repeated steps, and where feedback and rework happen.

TIP Ask the people who do the work, not only managers.

2

Pick one task

Choose a task that is frequent, rule-based, already digital and easy to measure. One task, not ten.

TIP Hatching plans, counting modules and checking names are classic first candidates.

3

Choose the route

Tool route: build a script or panel for one specific task. Investigation route: research which AI tools fit your company and plan how to bring them in.

TIP If the task depends on your own standards, a custom tool usually beats a generic app.

4

Pilot on a live project

Test on real files for 2–4 weeks. Measure the hours before and after, and note every error the tool catches or misses.

TIP No measurement before, no proof after.

5

Train and scale

Hands-on training on your own files, a short manual and one named owner per tool. Then pick the next task.

TIP A tool nobody owns stops being used.

SELF-ASSESSMENT

How ready is your company for AI?

Tick yes or no for each statement. Count one point for every yes.

01	We can name three tasks that repeat on every project.	☐ Yes ☐ No
02	We know roughly how many hours those tasks take each week.	☐ Yes ☐ No
03	Our drawings and models follow a layer or naming standard.	☐ Yes ☐ No
04	Our project data is digital and in one place, not only in PDFs and email.	☐ Yes ☐ No
05	Someone in the team is curious about scripting or AI.	☐ Yes ☐ No
06	Management can free a few hours a week for a pilot.	☐ Yes ☐ No
07	We have a rule about which project data may go into online AI tools.	☐ Yes ☐ No
08	We check model quality before sending it to clients or production.	☐ Yes ☐ No
09	We have a real, upcoming project to test a tool on.	☐ Yes ☐ No
10	We track the time spent per project phase.	☐ Yes ☐ No

0–3

Start with the map. Spend a month listing your steps and measuring hours before choosing any tool.

4–7

Ready for a pilot. Pick one task and test a tool on a live project.

8–10

Ready to scale. Train the team, name owners and plan the next tools.

PUT A NUMBER ON IT

What is repetitive work costing you?

Before you buy anything, calculate what one repetitive task costs per year. It tells you how much a tool or training is worth to you.

```
people × hours per week × weeks × cost per hour × share a tool takes over = saving per year
```

EXAMPLE

People doing the task	4
Hours per person per week	6
Working weeks per year	46
Internal cost per hour	€55
Share a tool could take over	40%
Repetitive hours per year	**1,104 h**

Possible saving per year

€24,288

4 × 6 × 46 = 1,104 h · × €55 = €60,720 · × 40% = €24,288

YOUR NUMBERS

People doing the task	
Hours per person per week	
Working weeks per year	
Internal cost per hour	
Share a tool could take over	
Possible saving per year	

Be conservative: a first tool usually takes over 30–50% of one task, not all of it.

What to do with the number

- ☐ Compare it with the cost of a tool or a training session. If the saving is several times higher, start a pilot.
- ☐ Count quality as well as hours: fewer errors in production or in the client's hands are worth extra.
- ☐ Repeat the calculation after the pilot with real measurements.

CASE · MODULAR TIMBER COMPANY

Model quality was good. The waste sat between people, deadlines and checks.

At a sustainable modular timber company, I reviewed four LVL projects. The diagnosis found three organisational gaps and one manual chain behind the rework.

ROOT CAUSE	WHAT HAPPENS	COUNTERMEASURE
No single feedback source Mail, calls, Excel	**Feedback lost or repeated** Unclear what is done, by whom	**One feedback tracker** Date, building, status
No binding timeline Input too early or too late	**Gaps and rework** Idle time, pushed deadlines	**Delivery dates at kickoff** Agreed with the client
No shared QA protocol Owners undefined	**Errors slip through** Wrong CNC elements	**QA checklist and owners** Now a live Rhino tool
Manual naming and counts Quantities multiplied by hand	**Mismatches in pricing** Double checks	**Automate in the database** Steps removed, checks merged

4
projects reviewed

24
process steps mapped

9→7
pricing steps

What it shows

- ☐ The first gain came from organising the process, before any AI.
- ☐ Then the QA checklist became a tool: a live panel in Rhino that scores model risk from 0 to 100.
- ☐ Manual counting moved into the database, which removed three manual pricing checks.

GROUND RULES

Six rules for using AI safely in your company

Agree on these before the first pilot. They protect your clients, your team and your reputation.

01

Keep client data safe

Don’t paste confidential models, drawings or contracts into public AI tools. Use business plans with data protection, or tools that run on your own computers.

02

Check every output

AI drafts, people decide. Check quantities, codes and calculations before they leave the office.

03

Keep responsibility with people

Structural, fire and legal decisions stay with qualified professionals, whatever a tool suggests.

04

Own your tools

Make sure you receive the source code and can change it without a subscription to one supplier.

05

Write it down

Document what each tool does and what it checks, so the knowledge stays in the company.

06

Know the rules

Follow GDPR for personal data and keep an eye on the EU AI Act. Keep a list of the AI tools you use and what for.

This guide is general guidance, not legal advice. Check specific obligations with your legal or data protection advisor.

ACTION PLAN

Your first 90 days with AI

A realistic plan for a small or medium-sized office. One task, one pilot, one decision.

DAYS 1-30

Map and choose

- ☐ Map your process from tender to delivery
- ☐ Measure the hours on repeated tasks
- ☐ Do the readiness check
- ☐ Agree a rule for project data and AI
- ☐ Pick one task

DAYS 31-60

Build and pilot

- ☐ Build or choose the tool
- ☐ Test it on a live project
- ☐ Measure before and after
- ☐ Collect feedback from the team

DAYS 61-90

Train and decide

- ☐ Train the team on their own files
- ☐ Write a short manual
- ☐ Name an owner for the tool
- ☐ Decide the next task

Common mistakes to avoid

- ☐ Starting with a big platform instead of one task
- ☐ Paying for subscriptions nobody uses
- ☐ Automating a broken process instead of fixing it first
- ☐ Leaving a tool without an owner
- ☐ Not measuring before you start

NEXT STEP

Want help with the first step?

I'm Lavinia Lorena Jilavu, a technical designer and BIM specialist working from Málaga. I helped bring AI into daily work at a modular timber company, and built around 30 Rhino and Python tools along the way. Now I help other teams do the same.

- ☐ **Free first session.** A half-day session on your own files to get to know each other, with no commitment.
- ☐ **Workflow audit.** Your process mapped, root causes named, and a ranked list of automations.
- ☐ **Custom tools.** Rhino, Python, Grasshopper, Revit and Dynamo tools, tested on your projects. You own the code.
- ☐ **AI training.** Hands-on sessions in English, Spanish or Italian, so the team keeps going on its own.

Book your free first session

Send me the type of projects you work on, one or two tasks that repeat on every project, and roughly how many people do that work.

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